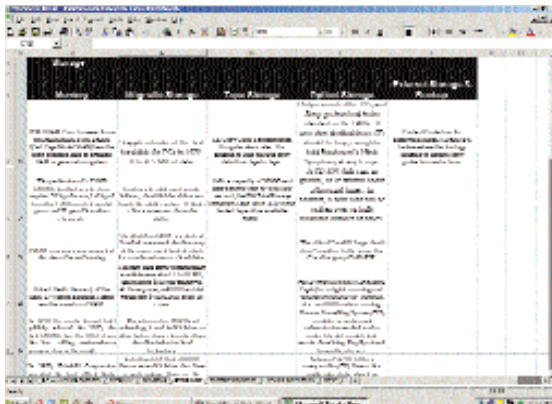




A Desktop snapshot can prevent a lot of bloodshed

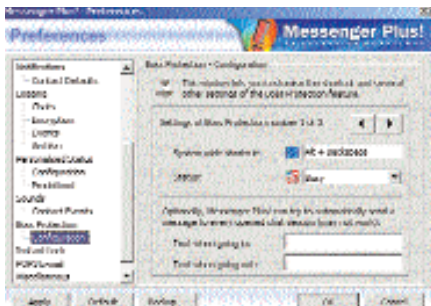
[Windows] + [D] (show desktop). Some people also prefer [Alt] + [Tab], always remembering to keep what's work related as the previous window visited. On a bad day, you end up looking like you weren't doing anything at all, or have something even worse pop on your screen.

The quick fix for this is to open up all the applications that you "should" be using, and press [Alt] + [Print Screen]. Now, go to **Start > Run**, type 'mspaint' and press [Enter]. This opens up Microsoft Paint. Press [Ctrl] + [V] to paste the captured image, go to **File > Save As** and save it as, say, 'desktop.bmp'. Then, go to **File > Set As Background (Centered)**. Right-click the Taskbar, select Properties, tick the 'Auto-hide the taskbar' checkbox and click OK.

Right-click on the Taskbar and go to **Toolbars > Desktop** to bring up the Desktop tab. Drag it to the extreme left, top, or right of your screen. Right-click on this new Desktop Taskbar and select Auto-Hide. Finally, right-click on the desktop and go to **Arrange Icons By > Show Desktop Icons** (uncheck it). Now, if your boss is a bit of a Nosy Parker, press [Windows] + [M], and it looks like you're hard at work.

8 Honour Thy Messenger

Most bosses are pretty lenient about Web surfing, but chatting is a



May Messenger Plus always protect you from your grumpy boss

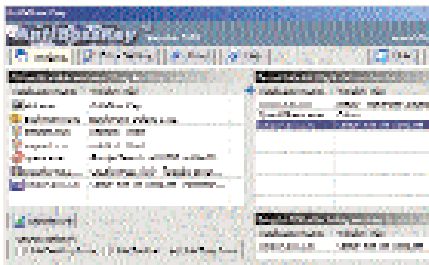
strict no-no. For times when the messenger is banned, use Messenger Plus from www.msgplus.net—a pretty impressive tool for MSN Messenger. It has some really cool MSN add-ons, including Boss Protection.

Download and install Messenger Plus, and the next time the Boss is looking, all you need to do is press [Ctrl] + [Spacebar]. This hides all open chat windows, and also changes the Messenger icon to anything else that you want—

the default is pretty good though. To change the Boss Protection settings, open the main Messenger window, and go to **Plus > Preferences > Boss Protection**.

7 Turn the other cheek

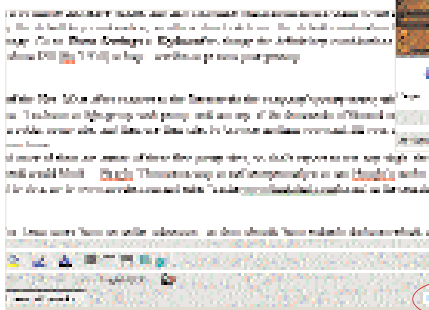
With a little help from a third-party utility, you can safeguard yourself from ever being caught. Anti-Boss Key (www.mindgems.com) is by far the best



Once you've configured Anti-Boss Key, getting caught would almost be a crime

solution to the problem. Download this utility, and install it. By default, it hides everything you've kept open—including what's on the taskbar. All you have to do is press [Ctrl] + ['] (the default setting), to hide all incriminating Windows—including the Anti-Boss Key window, of course.

But that's not all. You can also



set applications for it to ignore and leave visible, and also customise which application it brings to the foreground when you press your secret key combination. It can even launch that application for you, in case you didn't have a work related application running when your boss walked in.

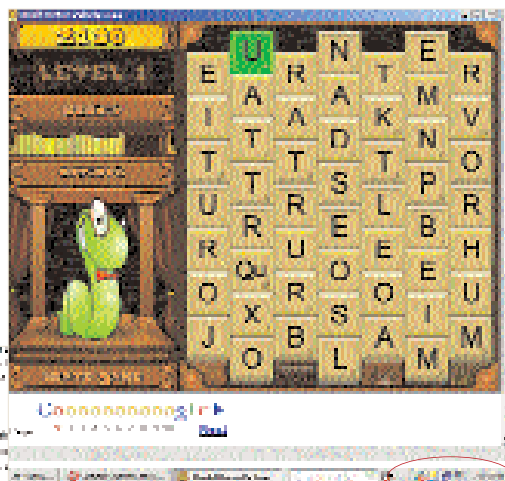
We suggest you change the default key combination. The default combination to hide and show the application itself is [Ctrl] + [']—which you also need to change. Go to **Extra Settings > Keyboard** to change the default key combinations. The only sore point here is that the software is a 20-day trial version, and costs about \$30 (Rs 1,350) to buy—worth it to protect your privacy.

6 Do not curse thy system administrator

The biggest problem we face is trying to surf the Internet. Most of us connect to the Internet via the company's proxy server, which means every little thing we do online is logged and can be traced back to the user. You have to fight proxy with proxy, and use any of the thousands of blessed souls out there offering free anonymous proxy servers.

All you have to do is visit a public proxy site, and then use these sites to browse anything you want. All your systems administrator will see is data going to, and coming from, this sole proxy Web site.

Of course, system administrators aren't dumb enough to be unaware of these sites, so don't use a single proxy for long.



Here you are relaxing by playing a quick game of BookWorm and your boss rounds the corner...thanks to Anti-Boss Key, all he sees is a Word document